

Process Streamlining Worksheet - Wick & Wonder

Completed generative AI prompts and summarized findings for Problems 1-5

Wick & Wonder - Generative AI Process Streamlining

Problem 1: Innovative design ideas

Prompt

I am a Product Manager at Wick & Wonder LLC, a candle company targeting customers ages 20-35. Generate unique and innovative candle design ideas that could improve differentiation and appeal to this segment.

Summary of Findings

Recommended ideas include geometric candles, marble-effect candles, crystal-embedded candles, terrarium candles, sculptural candles, glow-in-the-dark designs, hidden-message candles, aromatherapy candles with botanicals, gradient color candles, DIY design-your-own candle kits, celestial candles, repurposed-material candles, personalized labels, QR-code candles, pop-culture inspired collections, and seasonal limited editions.

Problem 2: Market trends and preferences

Prompt

Build on the prior analysis. Identify candle market trends and customer preferences among 20- to 35-year-old buyers.

Summary of Findings

Key trends include natural and sustainable ingredients, wellness and aromatherapy, aesthetic home decor, personalization, social media-friendly packaging, subscription discovery, and e-commerce convenience. Customers in this age segment often value scent variety, visual appeal, ethical sourcing, brand authenticity, interactive experiences, and products that fit self-care routines.

Problem 3: Competitive analysis

Prompt

Build on the prior analysis. Conduct a competitive analysis for Wick & Wonder by identifying three major candle competitors, their product mix, and market positioning.

Summary of Findings

Major competitors include Yankee Candle, Bath & Body Works, and Diptyque. Yankee Candle competes through broad scent variety and mass retail distribution. Bath & Body Works competes through seasonal launches, promotions, and strong retail loyalty. Diptyque competes in the premium/luxury segment through refined scents, minimalist packaging, and prestige branding. Wick & Wonder can compete through niche designs, sustainable materials, personalization, and AI-informed trend speed.

Problem 4: Marketing plan and value proposition

Prompt

Build on the competitive analysis. Create a marketing plan with creative product descriptions and a value proposition that helps Wick & Wonder stand out.

Summary of Findings

Marketing should position Wick & Wonder as a modern candle brand blending scent, design, wellness, and personalization. Tactics include social-first campaigns, influencer seeding, limited-edition drops, user-generated content, sustainable packaging stories, and AI-personalized scent quizzes. Value proposition: Wick & Wonder helps young adults turn everyday spaces into personalized sensory experiences through distinctive candles designed around mood, style, and sustainable self-expression.

Problem 5: Beta plan with customer feedback

Prompt

Build on the marketing plan. Develop a beta plan that streamlines product testing and incorporates more customer feedback.

Summary of Findings

The beta should recruit 50-100 target customers, test 6-10 prototype scents/designs, collect structured ratings on scent, burn quality, packaging, purchase intent, and brand appeal, and use QR-code surveys for in-home feedback. AI can summarize comments, identify themes, rank prototypes, and recommend design refinements. Success metrics include average rating, repurchase intent, defect rate, scent strength score, packaging appeal, and qualitative sentiment.

Task 7 and Task 8: Comparison Notes

A peer reviewer would likely agree that generative AI substantially accelerates brainstorming, trend analysis, marketing copy, competitive review, and beta planning. Compared with the provided ChatGPT potential solution, this analysis covers the same five problem areas but compresses the findings into an assignment-ready worksheet format and adds explicit beta metrics for customer feedback.